Nandivarma Style

The last stage of the Pallava architecture is also represented by structural temples built by the later Pallavas. The best example is Vaikunda Perumal temple at Kanchipuram.



Kanchi Vaikunda Perumal Temple

Society and Culture

The Pallavas supported Jainism, Buddhism and the Vedic faith. They were great patrons of music, painting and literature. Some of the Pallava kings patronised the Azhwars and Nayanmars. These exponents of Bhakti Cult preached a new form of Vaishnavism and Saivism. Among the Saivites were Appar and Manikkavasakar. Among the Vaishnavites were Nammazhvar and Andal. The Bhakti movement aimed at preaching a popular faith, in which prayers in Tamil were preferred to those in Sanskrit. Women were encouraged to participate in the religious congregations. The Tamil devotional cult was competitive with Buddhism and Jainism. Therefore the latter suffered a gradual decline in most parts of Tamil country.

Education and Literature

- Gatika (monastery or centre of learning) at Kanchi was popular during the Pallava times and it attracted students from all parts of India and abroad.Vatsyaya who wrote *Nyaya Bhashya* was a teacher at Kanchi (Gatika).
- The treatise on *Dakshin Chitram* (Paintings of South India) was compiled during the reign of Mahendravarma I.
- The great Sanskrit scholar, Dandin, adorned in the court of Narasimhavarma I. Dandin composed *Dashakumara Charita.*
- Bharavi, the great Sanskrit scholar, lived in the time of Simhavishnu. Bharavi wrote *Kiratarjuniya,* an epic in verses.
- Tamil literature had also flourished during the Pallava rule. *Thevaram* composed by Nayanmars and *Nalayradivyaprabantham* composed by Azhwars, which are still chanted by devout people. Perundevanar, who was patronized by Nandivarman II, translated the *Mahabharata* into Tamil as *Bharathavenba.*

Pallava Art

The Pallava kings had also patronised fine arts. The music inscriptions in Kudumianmalai and Thirumayam temples show Pallavas' interest in music. The famous musician Rudracharya lived during Mahendravarma I. The sculptures of this period depict many images in dancing postures.

The Chalukyas

The Chalukyas ruled larger parts of west and centre of South India, consisting of Maratha country with Vatapi (Badami)

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